



Project Close-out Report

Project Catalyst Fund 11 · Project #1100019

Name of project and Project URL on Catalyst

Project name	Afrocharts Web3 Artist Portal (Awen), delivered as Valt
Project URL on Catalyst	projectcatalyst.io/funds/11/cardano-use-cases-concept/afrocharts-or-web3-artist-portal-awen
Project number	1100019
Challenge	Fund 11, Cardano Use Cases: Concept
Name of project manager	Ian McCullough, Awen LLC
Date project started	11 March 2024
Date project completed	30 September 2026
Funding	ADA 100,000 across five milestones; this submission closes Milestone 5 (ADA 15,000)
Single URL hosting the outputs	www.valt.digital (testnet preview on Cardano preprod)
Close-out video	https://youtu.be/BKOK0YrLKKU (YouTube, public, 4:23)

Deliverables

- **Delivered:** a web3 artist portal where every song streams in full, fans collect limited editions with a Cardano wallet, and holding one unlocks the artist's private Valt with holder-only video. All five milestones delivered with published evidence.
- **On-chain evidence:** song NFTs under policy [bf5a88ac...](#) on preprod, including test purchases through the public checkout (payment and mint in one transaction).
- **Off-chain evidence:** milestone packs in github.com/Awen-online/valt/tree/main/docs.
- **Open source:** yes, the platform plugin, theme, tests and minting tools at github.com/Awen-online/valt.
- **Testing:** 19 automated tests in CI on PHP 8.1 to 8.3, a security scan on every push, recorded test cases (M3), a disclosed multi-wallet checkout test, and 38 rollout fixes documented with root cause.
- **User feedback:** in-product survey and 1:1 conversations (n = 5, NPS +60), plus named testimonials from the artists Mie and Hazy Jo (30 Sep 2026); see the Final Report, section 4.
- **Visual evidence:** screenshots in the Final Report and the M2 evidence pack.

List of challenge KPIs and how the project addressed them

Challenge: Fund 11, Cardano Use Cases: Concept.

Challenge KPI	How the project addressed it	Result
A real-world use case on Cardano	A working portal where independent musicians release limited song editions on Cardano and holding one unlocks the artist's private Valt, including holder-only music video. Live on the pre-production testnet with three artists and twelve songs.	Achieved
Proof of concept delivered and usable by the public	Public launch on 7 August 2026; anyone can stream, connect a wallet and collect; an in-page checkout pays and mints in one transaction; a How to collect guide for newcomers.	Achieved
Public usage of the portal	Open to the public since 7 August 2026: 78 unique visitors, 6 wallet-connected accounts (all time, including 1 admin), 17 editions collected through the in-page checkout in disclosed tests (see Usage).	Achieved
Open source contribution	Plugin, theme, tests and tools published at github.com/Awen-online/valt ; a critical CardanoPress wallet flaw found and fixed upstream (v1.36.1) with credit.	Achieved

List of project KPIs and how the project addressed them

Project KPI (milestone outputs and metrics)	Outcome	Status
M1 Initialization: analysis, project plan, agile board, repository	Delivered April 2024	Achieved
M2 Development: NFT-gated portal, integrations, launch partners	Portal, wallet connection, minting and token gating; signed partner opt-ins. Approved July 2026	Achieved
M3 Implementation: testing, security, feedback	Test suite and CI, six defects fixed, security assessment, feedback survey	Achieved
M4 Launch and rollout: public launch, announcements, bug documentation	Launch 7 Aug; posts on X, Instagram, LinkedIn, Facebook; 38 rollout defects resolved and documented	Achieved
M5 Closeout: feedback, artist evaluation, final report	Final Report, this Close-out Report	Achieved
Artists and catalog	3 artists, 12 songs live, 3 holder-only videos	Achieved
Wallet connect, public minting and token gating	CIP-30 wallet connection, public collect flow, per-artist token-gated Valts, holder-only video served by the server	Achieved
Checkout	Multi-edition collecting (1 to 5); in-page Anvil checkout with payment and mint in one transaction; mobile in-wallet browsers	Achieved
Launch communication	1,432 measured social reach and impressions; email to 842 recipients; artist and platform posts	Achieved
Feedback and testimonials	n = 5 (3 artists, 2 collectors), NPS +60; named testimonials from the artists Mie and Hazy Jo	Achieved
Artist evaluation	Recognition, opportunities and compensation evaluated for Cullah, Mie and Hazy Jo (Final Report, section 5)	Achieved
Artist pipeline	82 artist profiles on sync.land covered by signed terms that authorize Valt releases (76 added since July); 2 pitches to a Valt launch-feature brief	Achieved
Quality and open source	19 automated tests in CI; 38 rollout fixes, each traceable in the public code; public repository	Achieved

Usage

- 3 artists and 12 songs live; 3 holder-only videos.
- 78 unique visitors after launch (7 Aug to 30 Sep 2026); 6 wallet-connected accounts (all time, including 1 admin); 1 unsolicited artist application.
- 1,432 measured social reach and impressions; launch email to 842 recipients.
- 46 song NFTs on-chain (48 minted, 2 burned); 17 editions collected through the in-page checkout in disclosed tests; 0 third-party purchases on testnet so far.
- 82 artist profiles on sync.land covered by signed terms that authorize Valt releases (76 added since July).

Impact

Independent artists get limited, verifiable editions whose size and price they set, a private space for holders that they control, and rights that stay with them. For Cardano, Valt is an open, working example of token-gated music with server-enforced holder media, plus a critical security fix contributed upstream to CardanoPress (v1.36.1), which protects every site that uses the plugin. Artist income is not yet realized: one flat featuring fee was agreed, and edition income depends on mainnet.

Sustainability

Valt continues after the grant as an Awen LLC product alongside sync.land, which supplies the artist pipeline. Revenue will come from a platform share of edition sales once on mainnet. Further funding, including a future Catalyst proposal for an audited on-chain edition-sale contract, may be sought. The code stays open source under community stewardship: contributions are welcome, and Awen continues building.

Key achievements

- **Artists:** Cullah, Mie and Hazy Jo live with pages, full-track streaming and token-gated Valts holding a short film and two official music videos; a written license with Hazy Jo in which the artist keeps all rights.
- **Collaboration and engagement:** the artist's own launch post reached 875 people on Instagram, more than every Awen post together; sync.land, Awen's sister platform, now carries terms that bring 82 artist profiles into Valt's release pipeline.

- **Artist voice:** named testimonials from Mie ("make digital music feel valuable and ownable again without asking fans to become crypto users first") and Hazy Jo ("a platform that gives artists another way to present their music, connect with collectors, and explore new ways of earning from their work").
- **Critical security fix contributed to the Cardano ecosystem:** Awen found a critical wallet-authentication flaw in CardanoPress, the open-source WordPress plugin used across Cardano sites for wallet login, reported it privately, and it was fixed upstream in [v1.36.1](#) with credit to Cullah (valt.digital); the maintainer [acknowledged it publicly](#).
- **From NMKR Pay to an in-page Anvil checkout:** collecting first redirected to NMKR Pay's hosted checkout. When NMKR's testnet backend stalled (29 Sep) and multi-edition orders needed an undocumented price-list rule, we built an in-page checkout on the Ada Anvil transaction API: the fan's wallet signs one transaction that pays and mints 1 to 5 editions straight to the collector; the server verifies it before co-signing with the project's policy key; an edition ledger prevents double allocation, proven by a disclosed multi-wallet concurrency test; a live panel shows on-chain confirmation; and it works in mobile wallet browsers (VESPR). The result: faster and simpler, no redirect, payment and delivery atomic, and less dependence on one minting provider (NMKR still serves older songs).
- **Open-source concept, owned by the community:** the platform, tools, tests and every documented fix are public under the MIT license at [github.com/Awen-online/valt](#), for anyone to use, fork and build on.

Key learnings

- Artists are the distribution: their own audiences drive discovery far more than the platform's channels.
- Lead with the music. Fans value listening and access first; ownership gives them a reason to return.
- Wallets and crypto are a real barrier for music fans: collecting should feel like buying online, by card, as Mie and the survey both said; artists also need reliable payouts in local currency (Hazy Jo).
- Keep a second path for critical services, and verify every release end to end before announcing it.
- Plans change: the original Afrocharts integration became a standalone product, and the timeline ran well past 2024.

Next steps for the product or service developed

Next phase: to be tested and rolled out

- Mainnet rollout of the collect flow, starting with London by Hazy Jo, with first market sales to collectors.
- Direct per-artist payouts, so edition income reaches each artist.
- A card checkout and walletless custody, so fans can collect without owning crypto; mobile wallet connection and a lower entry price tier.
- An on-chain minting policy that enforces edition caps, price and the artist split, with an independent audit before mainnet.
- A uniform token metadata template and a refresh of the existing test tokens.
- A discovery-to-collector path and artist-led releases from the sync.land pipeline.

Final thoughts/comments

Valt shows that a Cardano-native release model for independent musicians works end to end: listen, collect, unlock. The technical goals were met and the code is open. Market adoption is the next phase: mainnet, a card checkout and the first sales to collectors. We thank Cullah, Mie and Hazy Jo, the sync.land artists, and the Catalyst community for their patience and support. Valt continues as an Awen product.

Links to other relevant project sources or documents

- Live portal: [www.valt.digital](#)
- Open-source repository: [github.com/Awen-online/valt](#)
- Milestone documents: [github.com/Awen-online/valt/tree/main/docs](#) (M1 to M5)
- M5 Final Report: [docs/M5_Closeout/M5_Final_Report.pdf](#)
- M4 Rollout Bug Log: [docs/M4_LaunchRollout/M4_Rollout_Bug_Log.pdf](#)

Link to Close-out video

<https://youtu.be/BKOk0YrLKKU> (YouTube, public, 4:23; also at [awen.online/valt-closeout](#))